



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Pietas Classical Christian School: Melbourne
School Website: <https://pietasclassical.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Pietas Classical Christian School Melbourne, FL (32940) demonstrates a clear Classical Christian orientation, with strongest evidence in Curriculum and Religious/Metaphysical Foundations. The school's public materials emphasize the seven liberal arts, Great Books, primary sources, dialogue and narration, and a Christian theological frame that shapes instruction and community life. Taken together with the school's stated mission and parent-partnership approach, the aggregate profile is CLASSICAL.

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall, the six-category synthesis yields a CLASSICAL classification, with one category (Pedagogy) showing partial Classical traits and one category (Faculty) lacking explicit Classical signals in public materials. The strongest needle-movers for further elevation toward a fully CLASSICAL standing are to more explicitly codify pedagogy and faculty as living examples of classical formation, and to publicly articulate liturgical/-communal practices and faculty profiles in line with the Classical School lexicon.

What would move the needle (for a move toward full CLASSICAL) - Pedagogy: Add explicit, public commitments to Scholé/restful learning and Socratic seminars in upper grades; publish a concrete pedagogy plan (teacher training, sample schedules, and exemplar dialogues) that foreground Socratic inquiry and disciplined discourse. - Faculty: Publish a formal "living curriculum" portrait of teachers; document faculty formation in classical pedagogy; highlight teacher exemplars and mentorship roles. - Religion/Community: If not already explicit, incorporate a stated liturgical or communal prayer/worship rhythm and clearly describe how theology informs cross-disciplinary work. - Parents & Community: Deepen parent formation efforts with structured book studies, webinars, and open-campus experiences to reinforce parents as co-educators.

Cited evidence and keyword grounding are integrated throughout the category analyses below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a theologically rich Christian frame, naming Augustine, Aquinas, the Reformers, and C.S. Lewis as lineage, and describes the program as "Theologically and philosophically rich

in the Christian tradition” with the Gospel of Christ shaping student formation. - Text emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and the aim of forming character within a Christian frame; the material notes “gaining wisdom and establishing virtue in mind, body, and soul” through classical arts. - The parent testimonial quotes “true, good, and beautiful,” echoing transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) as a lived aim.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; gospel; Christ; sacred tradition. - No explicit negative signals about theology or liturgy in the public materials. - The Classic Elements grid (Positive Keywords) supports these signals as aligning with “Grounded in Theology,” “Transcendental Moral Realism,” and “Liturgical/Communal Practices.” See Six Essential Elements positive keyword indicators including truth/goodness/beauty and theology.

Why this rating - The materials explicitly foreground a Christian theological frame, the order/realism of ultimate truths (truth, goodness, beauty), and formation in virtue and wisdom, all hallmarks of CLASSICAL orientation in the Religious/Metaphysical Foundations category. The presence of a strong theological umbrella and explicit language about sacred aims justifies CLASSICAL rather than weaker formulations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The language centers formation and virtue: “gaining wisdom and establishing virtue” and “kingdom living” with the Gospel in view, indicating formation over mere information and a teleological orientation toward human flourishing. - The public materials articulate truth/beauty/ goodness as real and knowable, and assert a mission that aligns with formation toward virtue and contemplation rather than narrow vocational outcomes. The parent quote about “true, good, and beautiful” underscores this teleology.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; human flourishing; truth/goodness/beauty as real; contemplation; teleology; Christian teleology (kingdom living). - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce- or college-placement readiness as primary goal; no secular or relativistic signals). - Grounding in the Positive Keywords framework for School Purpose and Goal (from the Six Essential Elements): formation, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, human flourishing.

Why this rating - The materials emphasize formation and virtue, with a teleology toward enduring truths and human excellence, aligning with CLASSICAL over a purely information-transfer or job-prep model.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum emphasis is explicit on the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) and “reading the great books on the great ideas,” with primary sources and dialogue/narration highlighted. - The Great Books / Great Conversation motif is central (explicitly cited as reading the Great Books; “great conversation” language appears in the material). - The text notes an integrated approach to the liberal arts within a historically rooted curriculum and a cultivation of wonder. The Great Books and primary sources signal the classical canon and engagement with Western intellectual heritage.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: seven liberal arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources; great conversation; wonder; integrated approach. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials. - The knowledge-base Positive Keywords for Curriculum content (from the Six Essential Elements) explicitly include the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books / primary sources, and inter-disciplinary harmony.

Why this rating - Curriculum content aligns directly with classical criteria: liberal arts core, Great Books, primary sources, and an emphasis on wonder and integrated study. This category is CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize dialogue and narration as part of learning processes, with an emphasis on reading great books, primary sources, and dialogic engagement. The exact reference to “dialogue” and “narration” signals some classical pedagogy elements, though there is no explicit articulation of a high-school-level Socratic seminar program or scholé cadence in the public materials. - There is no explicit, public description of Socratic seminars, rigorous upper-school debates, or formal rhetoric training in the Pietas materials, though the Great Books emphasis and dialogue language hint at some classical methods. The absence of explicit Socratic or scholé language (restful learning) suggests only partial alignment with the Pedagogy signals.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: dialogue; narration; poetry; primary sources; Great Books; “great conversation” (implicit Socratic dialogue-like engagement). - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit Scholé/restful learning, explicit Socratic seminars, or upper-level rhetoric training in public materials. - The Six Essential Elements pedagogy keywords include Socratic dialogue, Scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation. Public Pietas materials mention dialogue, but not explicit Socratic methods or Scholé.

Why this rating - The program demonstrates some classical pedagogy markers (dialogue, Great Books, primary sources) but lacks explicit, public commitments to key higher-level classical methods (Socratic seminars, Scholé-restful pedagogy, formal rhetoric training) in Grades 9–12. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

What would move the needle (Pedagogy) - Publicly commit to and implement Socratic seminars in upper grades with teacher training and exemplar dialogues. - Introduce Scholé (restful learning) elements into daily/weekly schedules; publish a plan with rest, contemplation, and time for deep reading. - Include formal memory work, chanting, or recitation as a regular practice in lower grades to deepen foundational knowledge. - Establish a visible rhetoric track (speech, declamation, oratory) in upper grades with student opportunities to present and critique.

Citations: Pietas materials show dialogue and Great Books focus; lack of explicit Scholé/Socratic signals is inferred from the public description.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials do not provide a faculty portrait, living-curriculum description, or explicit statements about teacher formation, mentorship, or model-teacher profiles. The absence of a publicly stated “faculty as living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” signal indicates insufficient signals for CLASSICAL in this category based on the available public materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords for Faculty (from the Six Essential Elements) include: teachers as models of virtue; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collegial culture; mentorship; character formation; virtuous exemplars. - The Pietas page contains no explicit statements about faculty being the living curriculum, virtue-models, or a formal faculty portrait; no direct reference to mentorship or collegial culture in the public materials. Therefore, negative signals are effectively present as a lack of explicit articulation. - The knowledge-base lexicon includes explicit faculty signals; absence on Pietas site yields a NOT CLASSICAL reading for this category, unless more evidence appears in other materials.

Why this rating - Without explicit public articulation of faculty as exemplars of virtue and living curriculum, this category does not meet the Classical criteria as strongly as others. The lack of explicit teacher portrait/formation signals justifies NOT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes parent involvement (parent-led schooling; three-day in-class instruction to assist parents in deeper home discussions). This points toward a true partnership with families and co-educative dynamics, aligning with classical-community signals. - The public materials feature a parent testimonial that praises the school for shaping biblical convictions and “true, good, and beautiful,” demonstrating a culture that values partnering with families in formation. - The presence of multiple campus locations and the invitation to parents to engage through discussions and information sessions align with the classical-family/community ethos of parent involvement.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; parental involvement; home-school collaboration; Christian family culture; family catechesis; living tradition in the family. - Negative keywords present: none in the public materials; no signals of consumer-model parent roles or minimal parent involvement. - The Six Essential Elements explicitly lists “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” as positive signals for Parents & Community. The Pietas materials show strong alignment with parent-partnership and parent support.

Why this rating - The Pietas materials clearly demonstrate a Classical-Community orientation with active parent involvement, family engagement, and a vision of parents as co-educators, justifying CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Implement explicit Scholé/restful learning practices and publicize a formal plan for Socratic seminars and a rhetoric-focused upper-school track. This would convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL by codifying the pedagogy signals.
 - Faculty (Element 5): Publish a formal “Living Curriculum” portrait of faculty and a faculty-development plan focused on classical pedagogy, virtue modeling, mentorship, and collegial practice to upgrade this category to CLASSICAL.
 - Liturgical/Communal Practices (Element 1): If not already explicit, articulate a public liturgical rhythm or communal worship-oriented practices that are integrated with the curriculum, strengthening the religious foundations and making the liturgical dimension explicit.
 - History of Western Civilization and Great-Books (Element 3): Continue to expand explicit cross-curricular integration with Great Books and primary sources across disciplines to deepen the Great Conversation and unity of knowledge, ensuring history is treated as the core through-line rather than a stand-alone subject.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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